

STUDY GUIDE IPC



Journalism and Photography



Dear International Press Members,

It is with immense pride that we welcome you all to the International Press Committee of MumbaiMUN 2024. This committee echoes the power of the press and gives the conference an enthralling burst of spontaneity.

In the world today, the power that news agencies and other mass media exercise is tremendous. Since with great power comes great responsibility, we encourage each and every one of you to exercise the voice that you have been given, not with restraint but with integrity; not with caution but with sensitivity; and lastly, not with presumptions but with an open mind.

An ideal reporter requires more research and presence of mind than an international delegation. The entire image of a press delegation without adequate research is flawed. Thorough research and background knowledge of all the committees is expected from all the reporters. Deadlines, hard work, flared tempers and running around will be plentiful, but the memories you create, the new people you meet and the knowledge you gain will outweigh them all.

This study guide gives you a gist of your roles and responsibilities for the conference. Please go through each section carefully and in case of any queries, feel free to contact us.

Regards

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JOURNALISM

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Follow a systematic and step-wise methodology to optimise your research and deliver it effectively:

1. Break down every word of the agenda yourself and make a note of concepts that you think are pertinent to them.
2. Read the background guide. Please note that just as the background guide is a basic tool for delegates, it is merely one aspect of your research.
3. Develop a literal understanding of the agenda.
4. Study the political, legal, social and economic aspects of the agenda. Go through articles, research papers or any relevant documents.
5. Read about the foreign policy and agenda perspective of nations that you might think will majorly impact the debate.
6. A thorough knowledge and understanding of contemporary events is a must. This ensures that your articles stay relevant.

Remember, your research accounts for more than 50% of all your written reports; do not simply rely on committee proceedings to draft a well-informed report. Research about each committee thoroughly, and it is highly encouraged for you to form your own opinions about certain aspects as you do so.

ROLES AND REPORTING

Roles of IP reporters

Committee Reports

The bulk of writing throughout the conference will consist of drafting a committee report for

each day of the MUN, which will include a brief account of the debates, caucuses, resolutions, and other committee proceedings observed by the reporters, backed by their own research.

The Committee Report should have a catchy title and byline. Irrelevant details should be omitted, and maintaining a streamlined flow of events in the report is of absolute importance.

Word Limit: 400-450 words

Report Count: 2 (one for each day of the conference)

Editorials and Op-Eds

Reporters may write Op-Eds after they have finished reporting from the council, which may include their take on the agenda, or any niche topic pertaining to the agenda. Op-Eds do not have to contain any information on what happened in the council/committee but concerns what the author thinks of the discussion at hand. Op-Eds have to be very high in standards of writing and expression. In clear words, Op-Eds differ from the Committee Report in matters of substance than events. Op-Eds are **not mandatory** but they definitely add up in the marking scheme.

Word Limit: 200 words/ 600 words

Report Count: Opted by Reporter

Interviews

An interview is an opportunity of a personal interaction with a delegate or EB member. It is an effective tool which should be utilized to bring out those aspects which will not come in light otherwise in the course of the MUN. Interview questions have to be crisp and relevant to the conference and committee, but some banter is allowed.

Reporters are allowed to record the interviewee's answers using mobile devices, which they will later transcribe and add to the Interview Report.

Reporters must make the interviewee aware that the conversation is on record before the start of the interview.

The Interview Report should contain the interviewee's name, designation, and other relevant details before the questionnaire.

Word Limit: 5-10 questions with transcribed answers.

Report Count: 1-2

Press Conference

The basic ingredient of the press conference is research. You will be allowed to ask 4-5 delegates of your committee polite subsidiary questions on the second day of the conference, with the prior permission of your Executive Board. You will be trained and guided by your IP Head for the press conference in the briefing. However, the opportunity to conduct a press conference will be subjected to the time constraints that the organizers have. Their permission and word will be deemed final.

The questions for the press conference must be approved by the IP Head, who must be called to committee when the press conference is to take place.

Tweets

Witty one-liners and catchy headlines from committee proceedings will make their way to social media pages for the IPC of MumbaiMUN 2024. Tweets do not have a marking scheme but are highly recommended.

STYLE GUIDE

All the reports must follow Associated Press (AP) style of report writing. A brief overview of the same is given below.

Abbreviating Words

These are the rules for common abbreviations following AP style:

- **Use only the most commonly recognized abbreviations:** The most common—such as NASA, FBI, and CIA—can be used on all references. Less well-known, but still common ones—such as OSHA and NATO—can be used after you spell out the full name on the first mention. In most cases, however, the stylebook suggests using a generic reference such as "the agency" or "the alliance" for all references after the first.
- **Don't put unfamiliar abbreviations in parentheses after the first reference:** "The American Copy Editors Society (ACES), for example, would either be repeated as the full name on subsequent references or replaced by a generic reference, such as "the society."
- **Use an apostrophe and spell out academic degrees:** "She holds a bachelor's degree." Use abbreviations for degrees only when you need to include a list of credentials after a name and set them off with commas: "Peter White, LL.D., Ph.D., was the keynote speaker."
- **Abbreviate junior or senior directly after a name, with no comma to set it off:** "Justin Wilson Jr."
- **Spell out the names of all states when used alone:** "He lives in Montana." Abbreviate state names of seven or more letters when used with a city name, with commas before and after the abbreviation: "Pittsburgh, Pa., is a great weekend getaway spot for people who live in Youngstown, Ohio."
- **Spell out the name of a month when it is used without a specific date:** "August is too hot for a visit to Florida." Abbreviate months with six or more

letters if they are used with a specific date such as "Sept. 28." Always spell out those with five or fewer letters: "May 15."

- **Spell out titles used alone:** "She was the first female senator from her state." Abbreviate and capitalize most titles when they are used directly before a name: "Sen. Boxer posed hard questions for Rice." To determine if a title is abbreviated, look for an entry for it in the AP Stylebook or check the listing under *Titles*.
- **Spell out titles with names used in direct quotes:** The exceptions are Dr., Mr., and Mrs. "Governor Pawlenty is obviously no Jesse Ventura," she said.
- **Spell out all generic parts of street names (avenue, north, road) when no specific address is given:** "The festival will be held on South Charles Street." When a number is used, abbreviate avenue (Ave.), boulevard (Blvd.), street (St.), and directional parts of street names: "The suspect was identified as Michael Shawn of 1512 N. Mission St."
- **In writing news stories, never abbreviate:**
 - The days of the week
 - Percent as %
 - The word "and," unless the symbol & is an official part of a name

Capitalization

The AP Stylebook uses what's known as downstyle—that is, words are lowercased unless a rule says to capitalize them. If you can't find a rule for capitalizing a word in the stylebook, use it in lowercase. The most familiar capitalization rules are:

- **Capitalize common nouns such as party, river, and street when they are part of a proper name for a place, person or thing:** For example, the

Libertarian Party, the Ohio River. But lowercase these common nouns when they stand alone or in subsequent references: "The party did not have a candidate for president," "She nearly drowned in the river." Lowercase all plural uses of common nouns: the Libertarian and Green parties, the Monongahela and Ohio rivers.

- **Lowercase the names of the seasons unless they are used in a proper name:** the Summer Olympics.
- **Capitalize the word "room" only when used with the number of the room or when part of the name of a specially designated room:** *Room 315, the Lincoln Room.*
- **Lowercase directional indicators:** The exception is when they refer to specific geographic regions or popularized names for those regions. For example, "the Northeast" or "the Midwest."
- **Lowercase formal titles that appear on their own or follow a name:** In the latter case, they should be set off by commas. Capitalize formal titles that come directly before a name: "The students were delighted when they heard they would meet President Obama." Never capitalize job descriptions: shortstop, police officer, attorney, and so on.

Numbers

The AP Stylebook entry for numerals is deceptively short. A close look reveals plenty of rules hiding among the cross-references. The most common are:

- **In general, spell out numbers one through nine:** Use figures for numbers 10 on up. However, there are many exceptions that always take figures. Most, but not all, involve units of measurement.

Common exceptions include:

- **Addresses:** 7 Park Place
- **Ages, but not for inanimate objects:** The 4-year-old cat, the four-year-old car
- **Cents:** 8 cents.
- **Dollars:** \$3. Notice that AP style does not include a period and two zeroes when referring to an even dollar figure
- **Dates:** March 4. Notice that dates take cardinal numbers, not ordinal numbers (don't use 4th)
- **Dimensions:** 5 foot 2, 5-by-9 cell
- **Highways:** Route 7
- **Millions, billions:** 6 billion people
- **Percentages:** 1 percent. Notice that percent is one word.
- **Speed:** 8 mph.
- **Temperatures:** 2 degrees.
- **Times:** 4 p.m. Notice that AP style does not include a colon and two zeroes when referring to an even hour.
- **Spell out numbers used at the beginning of a sentence:** "Ten thousand people marched on the capital." Exception: Never spell out years: "1999 was a terrible year for technology companies."
- **Use commas to set off each group of three digits in numerals higher than 999.** Exception is for years and addresses: "12,650."
- **Use decimals (up to two places) for amounts in the millions and billions:** Do this if no precise figure is required: "\$3.74 billion."
- **Add an "s" but no apostrophe to a number to make it plural:** "She kept rolling 7s." The same rule applies to decades: the 1980s. Use an apostrophe on a decade only if cutting off the initial figures: the '80s.

Punctuation and Miscellaneous

For the most part, AP style follows the same rules of punctuation taught in grade school. However, there are some important exceptions:

- **Don't use a comma before a conjunction in a simple series.** A simple series is defined as one in which no elements contain the words *and* or *or*: "The dinner choices were chicken, cod or beef." Use a comma for series that include elements containing *and* or *or*: "The menu offered a choice of bacon and eggs, pancakes, or waffles."
- **Use a semicolon to clarify a series that includes a number of commas:** Include a semicolon before the conjunction. "Parts for the carrier are made in Tampa, Fla.; Austin, Texas; and Baton Rouge, La."

Other Common Style Rules

Here are some more AP style guidelines to follow:

- **Use a person's full name on the first reference:** On subsequent references, use only his or her last name with no title. Second and following references to a married couple should refer to them as Mr. and Mrs.: "Mr. and Mrs. Oakes will honeymoon in Las Vegas." In stories in which two people share the last name, use full names on each reference.
- **Time:** Express as a figure followed by *a.m.* or *p.m.* "8:33 p.m." You do not have to add other words (e.g., night, morning, and so on) to distinguish between day and night. Use "noon" or "midnight" rather than 12 p.m. or 12 a.m.
- **Use hyphens to link all the words in a compound adjective:** "The five-volume report called for cleaning up the area over a 10-year period." Do not use a hyphen if the construction includes

"very" or an adverb ending in "-ly": "a very big project, barely legal procedures."

- **To form a plural of a single letter, use "s" and an apostrophe:** "All the B's lined up to the right." To form a plural of multiple letters, add "s" with no apostrophe: "She mastered her ABCs in little time."
- **To form the plural of words made out of a group of letters, add the letter "s":** CDs, ABCs, TVs.
- **Titles:** Books, movies, recordings, television shows, and similar works are set off in quotation marks, with all principal words capitalized: "Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows," "Letters from Iwo Jima," "Memory Almost Full," "Grey's Anatomy." Titles of magazines, newspapers and reference works get no special treatment: Newsweek, The Boston Globe, The Associated Press Stylebook.

For the detailed AP format, visit <https://www.apstylebook.com/>

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

- Submissions must be **on time**. Marks will be deducted for turning in the reports later than the decided time.
- Committee report for Day 1 must be submitted by the end of the last committee session of the day. Committee report for Day 2 must be submitted by the second last committee session of the second day.
- Editorials may be submitted to the reporters' convenience, before the end of the last committee session of the conference.
- Interview Reports must be submitted as per the IP Head's discretion.

- All typed reports must be emailed to sanya1213@gmail.com with correct headings and subject lines.
- All written reports (if any) must be handed to the IP Head physically.

CODE OF CONDUCT

- All reports should be neat, with a uniform font type and size maintained throughout. The font specifics should be formal and easy on the eyes.
- **Complete plagiarism of reports will not be tolerated.** While paraphrasing lines and quotes from different sources is a reporter's tool, plagiarism checks will be enforced to ensure authenticity of the entire report. This is applicable for the Committee Report as well as Op-Eds.
- Decent etiquette is to be maintained while interacting with members of the Executive Board, Organising Committee, delegates, and other people present in the conference.
- While in committee, maintain strict decorum. Do not move around or cause disturbance during formal committee sessions. Reporters are allowed to lobby during informal sessions.
- Press conferences tend to get spirited, but reporters are urged to maintain a calm demeanour and respectfully put forth their questions.
- **Use of derogatory remarks or colloquial language will result in mark deduction or disqualification from the International Press**, according to the IP Head's discretion.
- A positive and polite tone of voice is to be maintained in the Interviews and otherwise, throughout the conference.
- Following the formal dress code is applicable to the IP members as well.
- **The IP Head is not responsible for the misbehaviour of any of the IP Members.**

PHOTOGRAPHY

UNDERSTANDING EMOTIONS IN PHOTOGRAPHY

Why Emotions Matter In Visual Storytelling

Emotions are key to transforming an ordinary image into a compelling narrative in photography. Photographers communicate feelings like joy, grief, love, or fear through composition, lighting, body language, and facial expressions, strengthening their connection with the audience. These emotional cues engage viewers personally, enhancing the image's impact and memorability. Emotions also dictate the narrative, setting the mood and shaping how a scene is perceived. For instance, a photograph's emotional tone directly influences its mood, whether happy or sad. By transcending words, emotions allow photographers to connect with diverse audiences and evoke empathy. Whether in portraiture or conceptual work, emotions capture the essence of a subject and elevate ordinary moments into powerful ones.

The Core Emotions

Happiness: A positive emotion tied to joy and contentment, often shown through smiles or celebratory moments. It evokes warmth and connection.

Sadness: A negative emotion linked to loss or disappointment, captured through tears or somber expressions, evoking empathy and reflection.

Fear: Triggered by perceived threat, fear creates tension, often shown through wide eyes or tense body language, conveying vulnerability.

Anger: Driven by frustration or injustice, anger is intense and confrontational, depicted through clenched fists or harsh expressions.

Surprise: An emotion sparked by the unexpected, surprise can be positive or negative, shown through wide eyes or open mouths, capturing shock or wonder.

Techniques For Capturing Emotion

Capturing emotions requires keen observation of a person's facial expressions, body language, and their surroundings. Focus on candid shots where emotions like concentration, frustration, and excitement are revealed through gestures, posture, and eye contact. Use natural or available lighting to highlight dramatic moments, and wide shots to convey the overall atmosphere of the room. Timing is crucial to capture intense moments like speeches or voting. By blending close-ups with context shots, you can authentically document the emotional energy of the conference, from tense debates to moments of cooperation and triumph.

COMPOSITION TIPS

Composition refers to how elements are arranged within a photograph, including but not limited to the main subject. It is distinct from the subject itself, as it encompasses the entire frame. The human eye naturally prefers images with a sense of order and balance, while chaotic compositions are often less appealing. Good composition creates harmony and visual interest, while poor composition can detract from the image's impact. To improve composition, it's essential to understand and practice the various guidelines—often referred to as "rules"—that help structure an image effectively, keeping in mind that these are more flexible guidelines than strict rules.

Common Composition Techniques

The Rule of Thirds: The rule of thirds suggests dividing the image into nine equal sections, placing the subject at one of the intersecting

points rather than the center. This creates a more visually engaging composition, as the human eye tends to be drawn to off-center points of interest, making the image feel more balanced and dynamic.

Leading Lines: Lines, whether straight, diagonal, or curved, guide the viewer's eye through the photo. Leading lines can direct attention to specific elements, adding depth and drama. Diagonal lines, in particular, can create dynamic movement and a sense of infinity in an image.

Framing: In photography, a "natural frame" doesn't always mean a literal frame. It can refer to elements like doorways, arches, or tree branches that isolate the subject and direct the viewer's attention. By using natural frames, you can emphasize your subject and create a visual focus within the image.

Symmetry: Symmetry involves balancing both sides of an image to create harmony. It allows for breaking the rule of thirds and can be found in both nature and man-made elements. Look for symmetrical patterns, particularly those with strong lines or curves, which enhance the visual appeal of the image.

Viewpoint: The viewpoint can dramatically alter the mood of a photograph. For example, shooting a child from above makes them appear smaller or less significant, while shooting at eye level offers an equal perspective, and shooting from below can create a sense of dominance. Perspective also affects the perceived size of objects, such as emphasizing the height of a tree by shooting upward.

Understanding Technical Settings For Composition

Managing ISO and Noise: In a low-light environment like a classroom with artificial lighting, you might need to raise your ISO to capture enough light. However, increasing ISO

can introduce noise (grain) into the image. A good starting point might be ISO 800-1600 but test in your specific lighting conditions to find the optimal balance. You could also use noise reduction softwares during post-processing if necessary.

Slowing Down Shutter Speed: If you're dealing with light banding or flicker from artificial lights, slowing down the shutter speed can help reduce this effect. Artificial lighting, especially fluorescent or LED lights, may cause a flickering effect that appears as horizontal bands across your images. A slower shutter speed can help smooth out this flickering. However, be mindful of motion blur if your subject is moving. A tripod can help stabilize the shot if you're using slower shutter speeds.

White Balance Adjustment: Cool, white/blue artificial lights often result in images with a cold, unnatural color cast. Adjust your camera's white balance to compensate for this.

Grid Lines for Composition: To help with compositional balance and alignment, enable the grid lines on your camera's viewfinder or screen. These lines divide the frame into thirds, both horizontally and vertically, which aligns with the rule of thirds. Using grid lines can assist in positioning your subject or focal point at key intersections, creating a more dynamic and visually pleasing image.

GRADING CRITERIA

Each section will be scored out of a specific maximum total, and the final score will be a combination of the scores from each section.

Emotions (10 photos total)

Capture 2 photos for each of the 5 core emotions (happiness, sadness, anger, fear, and surprise). Submissions will be graded based on:

Emotion Authenticity: Does the photo effectively convey the core emotion? Are the subject's facial expressions, body language, and overall mood clear and authentic?

Composition and Technique: Is the image technically well-executed with appropriate focus, exposure, and framing that enhances the emotional impact?

Organizing Committee (5-10 photos total)

Capture 5-10 photos of Organizing Committee (OC) members at work, focusing on candid moments and behind-the-scenes actions. Submissions will be graded based on:

Storytelling: Does the photo capture the behind-the-scenes action or effort of the Organizing Committee? Does it provide insight into the OC's role and the event's inner workings?

Composition: Are the photos well-composed, dynamic, and visually engaging? Do they capture the energy and movement of the OC members?

Composition Types (5 photos total)

Submit 1 photo each for 5 different composition techniques: Rule of Thirds, Leading Lines, Framing, Symmetry, and Viewpoint. Submissions will be graded based on:

Execution: Does the photographer effectively use the chosen compositional technique in a creative and visually striking way? Is the rule clearly incorporated into the shot?

Technique: Is the image technically well-executed with appropriate focus, exposure, and framing that enhances the emotional impact?

Miscellaneous Photos (5 photos total)

Submit 5 miscellaneous photos that don't fit the other categories. Submissions will be graded based on:

Creativity and Innovation: Are the photos unique, imaginative, or taken from an interesting perspective? Do they offer a fresh approach to capturing the event?

Relevance and Impact: Does the photo add depth to the overall narrative of the event? Does it convey a significant or memorable moment in the event?

SUBMISSIONS GUIDELINES

Submission Deadline

The deadline for submission will be decided before the commencement of committee sessions. Submissions must be on time, failure to do so will lead to a reduction in marks.

Image Editing

Editing is not mandatory; however, if you choose to edit your images, please keep adjustments minimal. Avoid over-editing, such as excessive sharpening, saturation, or heavy filters. The goal is to enhance the photo while preserving its natural look and authenticity.

Submission Method

All images must be uploaded to the provided drive link. Photographers are required to create their own folder and organize their photos into 4 separate folders, one for each category:

1. Emotions
2. Compositions
3. Miscellaneous
4. Organizing Committee (OC)

Name each photo according to its category and specific emotion or composition type. Example:

1. emotion_happiness_1.jpg
2. composition_ruleOfThirds_1.jpg
3. misc_1.jpg
4. oc_1.jpg

Please ensure your files are well-organized and clearly labeled to facilitate the grading process.

REFERENCES

- <https://www.apstylebook.com/>
- <https://www.thebalancesmb.com/associated-press-cheat-sheet-1360728>
- <https://ipumun.files.wordpress.com>
- <http://www.hillwoodsindia.org/>